

4 Hawthley Road
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Dear Sir

Thank you for your letter - I am disappointed
you think I have gone too far: that, of course,
is just the point I wanted to know about.

When I read your "Knowledge of the External
World" I felt that you hadn't gone far enough:
but I could not see why until I read Vaihinger.
Vaihinger has been to me what Frege has been
to you. Of course, I never meant to say that we
can know nothing of natural phenomena: if
you read that, I must have expressed myself
very badly. I am afraid I am presumptuous, but
to put it quite frankly, I feel that Vaihinger
has helped me to go a step further than any-
thing in your published books: that is why I
asked you to read the part that is meant to
explain this first step -

If I understand your position correctly, you
say that a table can be seen as an 'aspect':
what I see is one 'view' of the table: you admit
in fact, that I do 'see' a table in the ordinary
sense of the word. I cannot persuade myself that

We know anything except that there is a 'raw material' out of which we construct our 'things' - a raw material which is & must be always quite unknown to us, if only because we are limited to only a part. If in mathematics we can have certainty because we hold to ^{the} ONE and despise the WHAT: why not in all knowledge? It may be my mathematical ignorance, but I cannot see the logical difference between a name & a number: in mathematics you are content with five without asking for the what: why not be content with the name cat without asking for the what? And I cannot understand why you should be content with $\sqrt{2}$ and yet go hunting for a "typical Frenchman". The difficulty - if it is a difficulty - is the same in both.

People like Lord who are trying to find out what an egg does have the laboratories of the world at their disposal. Nobody seems to think of experiments when it is only what the egg is that is in question. I should like to have a chance of trying to prove experimentally that you can't see the fath! I can't believe that it is impossible to devise such experiments.

With very many thanks.

Yours faithfully
W.O. Driessche